

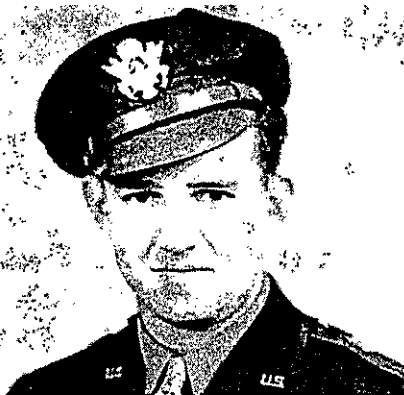


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Alexandria, VA 22304-2907

Fifty years of gratitude to an enemy

by Bob Sheeran



1943.

You may find this hard to believe but Charlie Brown, of Miami, FL, became an AFOSISA member as a direct result of a WWII happening. Long after the fact, of course, but still, Charlie's becoming a member in December 1992 was unquestionably tied to what happened to him over Germany on 20 December 1943, 49 years earlier. Our good member Joe Jones, Savannah, GA, was responsible for merging Charlie's past with our Association.

You longer-term members will recall an article I wrote about Joe titled "Lucky Joe" which was contained in the January 1986 issue of our magazine. For newer members that article described how Joe Jones, a 19-year-old B-17 tail gunner, survived a mid-air collision over Belgium on 1 March 1945, in which the tail of his plane was severed from the body of the B-17 and, with Joe trapped inside, fell 13,500 feet. Only slightly injured, he was back in England a few weeks

later flying missions. He became known throughout the Eighth Air Force as "The luckiest man in the Eighth."

Following a long post-war career with OSI and DIS, Joe has been an active and involved member of the Eighth Air Force Association and its auxiliary, the Eighth Air Force Historical Society.

In August 1992, he was attending the latter organization's Southeast Regional Meeting at Orlando, FL. A friend approached him and told him of another attendee who wanted to have his picture taken with Joe so there would be a photo of "the TWO luckiest men in the 8th." Joe was introduced to Charlie Brown and the photo was taken as shown here.



1992. Orlando.

During the discussion that followed, Charlie related how he had been spared certain death during WWII by the chivalrous and gallant action of an enemy Luftwaffe pilot that was reminiscent of the days of King Arthur and his Knights of the Round Table.



1965.

He further told Joe of his subsequent work with the State Department which consisted of investigative assignments on an international level. Ever the good OSI Agent, Joe asked Charlie where he had gotten his investigative training or experience. In writing me of this meeting, Joe wrote, "His answer should not have surprised me but it gave me a real lift when he told me he'd been in OSI prior to the State Department work." And, as is said, the rest is history. Joe sent Charlie a Membership Application and, following Joe's letter to me, I have been in written and phone contact with Charlie Brown. He has furnished me with documents, newspaper and magazine articles and photographs regarding his WWII experience with the Luftwaffe pilot to whom he credits his life today, and has told me of his post-war history.

For an account of that 1943 encounter and his subsequent 30-year's career in Federal service, please turn to page 6.

CHARLES E. BROWN

[REDACTED] was born at [REDACTED] on [REDACTED]. He joined Co. E, 201st Infantry of the W. Va. National Guard just prior to his 17th birthday in October 1939. Upon graduation from Weston High School in June 1940 he joined the Signal Corps of the Regular Army. He became an Aviation Cadet in July 1942 and was graduated as a U. S. Army Air Forces pilot in April 1943. He arrived in England in early Nov. 1943 as a B-17 Pilot/Aircraft Commander and flew 29 bomber combat missions (24 over Germany proper) with the famed 379th Bomb Group until April 11, 1944. He then delivered fighters and bombers, and flew transports from North Ireland around the United Kingdom until Mid-August 1944. After home leave he became an Instructor Pilot in B-17s and Asst. Ops. Officer at Avon Park, Fl. He again volunteered for overseas duty and completed training as a pilot of C-87 and C-54 transport type aircraft. He departed San Francisco, CA on Sept. 2, 1945 as a C-54 pilot with stops at Hawaii; Johnson Island; Kwajalein; Guam; Manila; and Kunming, China; arriving at Dacca, then Calcutta in India. After a few flights in the China-Burma-India Theater, including two flights over the famed "Hump", he returned to the United States by the same route in October 1945 and upon separation on Dec. 1, 1945 was promoted to Captain in the Army Reserve.

After completing West Virginia Wesleyan College in 1949 he joined the newly formed U. S. Air Force and received a Regular Air Force Commission. Early in his career the U. S. Air Force sponsored a full calendar year of graduate studies at the George Washington University resulting in his receipt of a M. A. Degree in Government, plus fifteen graduate hours. He served with HQ. United States Air Force; HQ. U. S. Air Forces Europe; HQ. Tactical Air Command; HQ. Royal Air Force, U.K.; and Organization Joint Chief Of Staffs. In 1965 he declined promotion to Colonel in order to request early voluntary retirement as a Lt. Col. to accept appointment (and promotion) as a Senior Foreign Service Reserve Officer. During the Vietnam War he served for six continuous years in Southeast Asia with the Foreign Service, with most of the time spent in and around Laos and Vietnam. During fifteen years of serving abroad as a Military or Foreign Service Officer, he received numerous U. S. and Foreign awards, citations, commendations, etc. for his app. nine years of service in and around a combat zone.

After thirty years of government service, he retired in 1972 and moved to Miami, FL. He formed a combustion research company in 1974, concentrating on energy and environmental research, and has worked as a research scientist/inventor and CEO since that date. He has also received national and international recognition for his research efforts to include: his 1980 selection as one of the six outstanding energy inventors in the United States by the research staff of the "NBC TODAY SHOW," and selection as "1987 NATIONAL INVENTOR OF THE YEAR" (in competition with all U. S. inventors), by the Palm Beach Society of American Inventors, Inc.. In 1992 he was also recognized by the Governor of West Virginia with a "Distinguished West Virginian Award," both for his government service and subsequent civilian careers.

12-12-00

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] FL [REDACTED]

DOB: [REDACTED]; Wife: [REDACTED]

SUMMARY OF EDUCATION AND EMPLOYMENT

- 1) June 1940-Dec. 1945 U. S. Army, Bomber Pilot Europe, and Transport Pilot Pacific. Oct 1946-Oct.1947: Cdr. U. S. Army CIC Unit in Japan; returned to college.
- 2) Education: Graduated W. Va. Wesleyan College Aug. 1949 (AB); The George Washington Univ. Aug. 1955 (MA); current Ph D Candidate, Kennedy-Western Univ.; completed multiple service schools to include the Armed Forces Staff College.
- 3) Active duty: Oct. 1949 -- June 1965 Regular Officer, U. S. Air Force. Extensive service in Europe, Middle East, Virginia, and Washington D. C. areas. Served 3½ years as Exchange Officer, in Wg. Cdr's. post Royal Air Force, United Kingdom. Last military assignment: Organization Joint Chiefs of Staff. Took early retirement to accept appointment as a Senior Foreign Service Reserve Officer. Served 1965 - 1971 in Southeast Asia as Regional Inspector or Inspector In Charge, A.I.D., U. S. Dept. of State.
- 4) Retired 1972 with 30 years total govt. service, including 15 years of foreign service assignments.
- 5) 1974 to date -- Inventor/Research Scientist -- President of Combustion Research Co..

SPECIAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS OR AWARDS

- 1) Received several U.S. and foreign decorations, awards, commendations, and citations.
- 2) Received national and international recognition for scientific achievement in the field of combustion research; especially for "Project Smokeless Diesel." Awards include: a) 1st place winner in mechanical or chemical categories in the three Florida Inventors' Competitions entered; b) the Tisdelle Award in 1983 for "Best Of Show" in Florida Inventors Seminar/Exhibit; c) "Society Inventor Of The Year" 1984 and "National Inventor of The Year" 1987 (in competition with nominees from all states) by the Palm Beach Society of American Inventors, Inc.; d) Recognition in March 1980 by the Research Staff of the NBC "Today Show" as one of the Six Top Energy Inventors in the United States; and e) "Distinguished West Virginian Award" by Governor of W. Va. Sept. 1992.
- 3) Past President (1988/89) and current President 1999/2000 of Pilot Class 43-D Assn., Inc., a national organization of several hundred former WWII pilots. (9/00)